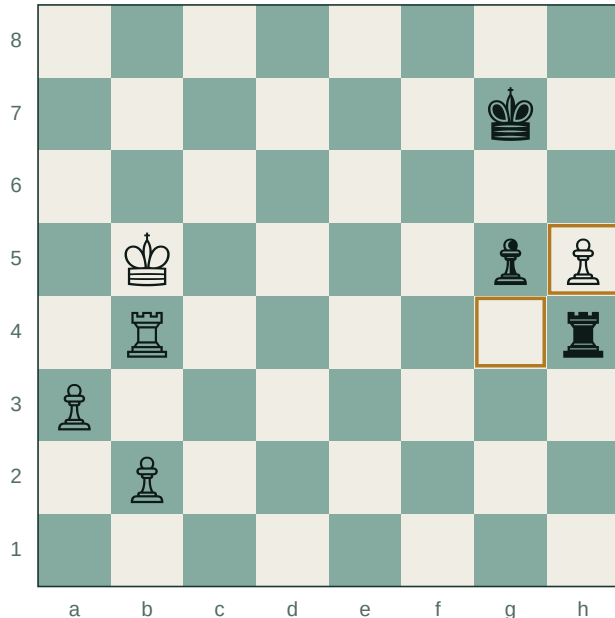


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 45

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 45.gxh5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45...Rxb4+ 46. Kxb4 g4

45...Rxb4+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on b4. Recorded reply: **46.Kxb4.**

46...g4 The pawn moves from g5 to g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on b5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.